



# ARIZONA HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES FLOOR AMENDMENT EXPLANATION

*57th Legislature, 2nd Regular Session*

*Majority Research Staff*

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**HB 2497: right to hunt; fish; harvest**

## **WAY FLOOR AMENDMENT**

1. Removes *the Legislature* as an entity prohibited by this act from enacting or adopting unreasonable restrictions related to hunting and fishing. (Sec. 1)
2. Makes additional technical changes. (Sec. 1)

WAY SUBSTITUTE FLOOR AMENDMENT  
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES AMENDMENTS TO H.B. 2497

I move the following SUBSTITUTE amendment to the LAND, AGRICULTURE & RURAL AFFAIRS  
Committee Amendment to  
HOUSE BILL 2497 (Reference to printed bill)

Amendment instruction key:

[GREEN UNDERLINING IN BRACKETS] indicates text added to statute or  
previously enacted session law.  
[Green underlining in brackets] indicates text added to new session law  
or text restoring existing law.  
[GREEN STRIKEOUT IN BRACKETS] indicates new text removed from statute  
or previously enacted session law.  
[Green strikeout in brackets] indicates text removed from existing statute,  
previously enacted session law or new session law.  
<<Green carets>> indicate a section added to the bill.  
<<Green strikeout in carets>> indicates a section removed from the bill.

1 The bill as proposed to be amended is reprinted as follows:

2 Section 1. Title 17, chapter 1, article 1, Arizona Revised  
3 Statutes, is amended by adding section 17-106, to read:

4 17-106. Right to hunt, fish and harvest wildlife; public  
5 policy

6 A. THE CITIZENS OF THIS STATE HAVE A RIGHT TO LAWFULLY HUNT, FISH  
7 AND HARVEST WILDLIFE.

8 B. AS PRESCRIBED IN SECTION 17-102, WILDLIFE IS THE PROPERTY OF  
9 THIS STATE AND IS HELD IN TRUST FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE CITIZENS OF THIS  
10 STATE.

11 C. THE LEGISLATURE HAS EXCLUSIVE AUTHORITY TO REGULATE THE MANNER,  
12 METHODS AND SEASONS FOR HUNTING, FISHING AND HARVESTING WILDLIFE. THE  
13 LEGISLATURE MAY DELEGATE THE RULEMAKING AUTHORITY TO THE [GAME AND FISH]  
14 COMMISSION AS PROVIDED IN THIS TITLE.

15 D. [THE LEGISLATURE AND] THE [ARIZONA GAME AND FISH] COMMISSION  
16 [MAY] NOT ENACT OR [MAY] ADOPT ANY [LAW,] RULE OR POLICY THAT UNREASONABLY

1 RESTRICTS HUNTING, FISHING AND HARVESTING WILDLIFE OR THE USE OF  
2 TRADITIONAL MEANS AND METHODS.

3 E. IT IS THE POLICY OF THIS STATE THAT PUBLIC HUNTING AND FISHING  
4 ARE THE PREFERRED MEANS OF MANAGING AND CONTROLLING WILDLIFE.

5 F. THIS SECTION DOES NOT MODIFY ANY PROVISION OF COMMON LAW OR ANY  
6 LAW OF THIS STATE RELATING TO TRESPASS OR PROPERTY RIGHTS.

7 Sec. 2. Short title

8 This act may be cited as the "Arizona Right to Hunt Act".

9 Enroll and engross to conform

10 Amend title to conform

MICHAEL WAY

2497FloorWAY.docx  
02/18/2026  
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